# Jeff Bezos

## A Comprehensive Research Biography

14 July 2026

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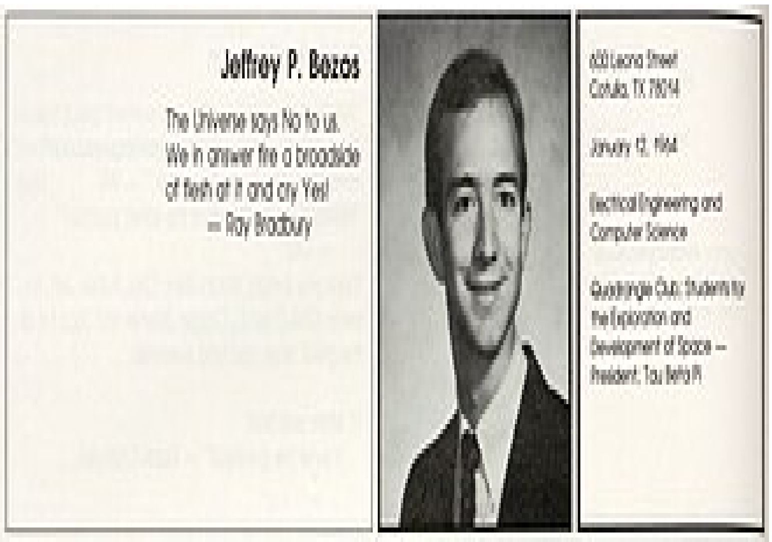
# Chapter 1

## Introduction

Jeffrey Preston Bezos ( BAY-zohss; né Jorgensen; born January 12, 1964) is an American businessman, and the founder, executive chairman, and former president and CEO of Amazon, the world's largest e-commerce and cloud computing company. According to the Bloomberg Billionaires Index and Forbes, he was the world's wealthiest person from 2017 to 2021, and in 2026 his net worth was approximately US$284 billion. Bezos was born in Albuquerque, and raised in Houston and Miami. He graduated from Princeton University in 1986 with a degree in engineering. He worked on Wall Street in a variety of related fields from 1986 to early 1994. He founded Amazon in mid-1994 on a road trip from New York City to Seattle. The company began as an online bookstore and expanded to a variety of other e-commerce products and services, including video and audio streaming, cloud computing, and artificial intelligence. It is the world's largest online sales company, the largest Internet company by revenue, and the largest provider of virtual assistants and cloud infrastructure services through its Amazon Web Services branch. Bezos founded the aerospace manufacturer and sub-orbital spaceflight services company Blue Origin in 2000, and he flew into space on Blue Origin NS-16 in 2021. He purchased the major American newspaper The Washington Post in 2013 and manages many other investments through his venture capital firm, Bezos Expeditions. The first centibillionaire on the Forbes Real Time Billionaires Index, Bezos was named the "richest man in modern history" after his net worth increased to $150 billion in July 2018 (equivalent to $190,000,000,000 in 2025). On July 5, 2021, Bezos took over the role of executive chairman and stepped down as the CEO and president of Amazon, succeeded by Amazon Web Services CEO Andy Jassy.

# Chapter 2

## Image Gallery





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# Chapter 3

## Career and Contributions

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## Early life and education

Bezos was born Jeffrey Preston Jorgensen on January 12, 1964, in Albuquerque, New Mexico, to Jacklyn (née Gise) (1946–2025) and Ted Jorgensen (1944–2015). At the time of his birth, his mother was a 17-year-old high-school student and his father was 19. Ted was a Danish American unicyclist born in Chicago to a family of Baptists. After completing high school despite challenging conditions, Jacklyn attended night school, bringing her baby with her. Jeff attended a Montessori school in Albuquerque when he was two. Ted struggled with alcohol and with his finances. Jacklyn left her husband to live with her parents, filing for divorce in June 1965 when Jeff was 17 months old. After his parents divorced, his mother married Cuban immigrant Miguel "Mike" Bezos in April 1968. Shortly after the wedding, Mike adopted 4-year-old Jeff, whose surname was then legally changed from Jorgensen to Bezos. Jacklyn, her husband, and her son left the area and asked Ted to discontinue contact, to which he agreed. After Mike received his degree from the University of New Mexico, the family moved to Houston, Texas, so that he could begin working as an engineer for Exxon. Jeff attended River Oaks Elementary School in Houston from fourth to sixth grade. Jeff's maternal grandfather was Lawrence Preston Gise, a regional director of the U.S. Atomic Energy Commission (AEC) in Albuquerque. Gise retired early to his family's ranch near Cotulla, Texas, where his grandson would spend many summers in his youth and which he would later purchase and expand from 25,000 acres (10,117 ha) to 160,000 acres (64,750 ha). Jeff displayed scientific interests and technological proficiency and once rigged an electric alarm to keep his younger half-siblings out of his room. The family moved to Miami, Florida, where Jeff attended Miami Palmetto High School. In high school, he worked at McDonald's as a short-order line cook during the breakfast shift. Bezos attended the Student Science Training Program at the University of Florida. He was high school valedictorian, a National Merit Scholar, and a Silver Knight Award winner in 1982. In his graduation speech, Bezos spoke about the possibility of human space colonization. A local newspaper quoted him as saying that he hoped humanity would eventually move heavy industry and large populations into space while preserving Earth as "a huge national park". After graduating from high school in 1982, Bezos attended Princeton University. He initially majored in physics but later switched to electrical engineering and computer science. In 2018, during a talk at the Economic Club of Washington, D.C., Bezos revealed that, some thirty years ago, his Princeton classmate Yasantha Rajakarunanayake had defeated him in solving a mathematical problem, causing him to give up on his dreams of becoming a theoretical physicist. Bezos was a member of the Quadrangle Club, one of Princeton's 11 eating clubs. Additionally, he was the president of the Princeton chapter of the Students for the Exploration and Development of Space (SEDS). He had a 4.2 GPA and was elected to Phi Beta Kappa and Tau

Beta Pi. Bezos graduated from Princeton in 1986 with a Bachelor of Science in Engineering (BSE), summa cum laude.

# Business career

## Early career

After Bezos graduated from college in 1986, he was offered positions at Intel, Bell Labs, and Andersen Consulting, among others. He first worked at Fitel, a financial technology telecommunications start-up, where he was tasked with building a network for international trade. Bezos was promoted to head of development and director of customer service. He transitioned into the banking industry when he became a product manager at Bankers Trust from 1988 to 1990. From 1990 to 1994, he worked at D. E. Shaw & Co, a newly created hedge fund with a strong emphasis on mathematical modeling. Bezos became D. E. Shaw's fourth senior vice president by age 30.

## Amazon

In spring 1994, Bezos read that web usage was growing at a rate of 2,300% a year and eventually decided to establish an online bookstore. He and his then-wife, MacKenzie Scott, left their jobs at D. E. Shaw and founded Amazon in a rented garage in Bellevue, Washington on July 5, 1994, after writing its business plan on a cross-country drive from New York City to Seattle. Bezos led the company's early development while MacKenzie Scott handled bookkeeping, financial administration, and some of Amazon's early freight negotiations during its startup phase. Before choosing Seattle as Amazon's headquarters, Bezos reportedly explored locating the company on a Native American reservation near San Francisco, partly because of potential tax advantages. Bezos initially named his new company Cadabra but later changed the name to Amazon after the Amazon River in South America, in part because the name begins with the letter A, which is at the beginning of the alphabet. At the time, website listings were alphabetized, so a name starting with "A" would appear sooner when customers conducted online searches. In addition, he regarded "Amazon," the name of the world's largest river, as fitting for what he hoped would become the world's largest online bookstore. He accepted an estimated $300,000 (equivalent to $700,000 in 2025) from his parents as an investment in Amazon. He warned many early investors that there was a 70% chance that Amazon would fail or go bankrupt. Although Amazon was originally an online bookstore, Bezos had always planned to expand to other products. Three years after Bezos founded Amazon, he took it public with an initial public offering (IPO). In response to critical reports from Fortune and Barron's, Bezos maintained that the growth of the internet would overtake competition from larger book retailers such as Borders and Barnes & Noble. In 1998, Bezos diversified into the online sale of music and video, and by the end of the year he had expanded the company's product offerings to include a variety of other consumer goods. Bezos used funds raised during the company's 1997 equity offering (equivalent to $110,000,000 in 2025) to finance the acquisition of smaller internet companies during the dot-com expansion period. Among these acquisitions were a purchase of a majority stake in Pets.com in 1999 and a purchase of a portion of Kozmo.com for $60 million (equivalent to $120,000,000 in 2025), both of which failed after the dot-com bubble collapse in 2000. By the end of 2000, Bezos borrowed $2 billion from banks (equivalent to $3,700,000,000 in 2025), as Amazon's cash balances dipped to only $350 million (equivalent to $650,000,000 in 2025). However, the company continued to expand despite its losses, and in 2002, Bezos led Amazon to launch Amazon Web Services, which compiled data from weather channels and website traffic. Revenues stagnated later that year, and after the company nearly went bankrupt, Bezos closed distribution centers and laid off 14% of the Amazon workforce. In 2003, Amazon rebounded from financial instability and turned a profit of $35 million (equivalent to $61,000,000 in 2025). In November 2007, Bezos launched the Amazon Kindle. According to a 2008 Time profile, Bezos wished to create a device that allowed a "flow state" in reading similar to the experience of video games. In 2013, Bezos secured a $600-million contract (equivalent to $830,000,000 in 2025) with the Central Intelligence Agency (CIA) on behalf of Amazon Web Services. In October of that year, Amazon was recognized as the largest online shopping retailer in the world. In May 2016, Bezos sold slightly more than one million shares of his holdings in the company for $671 million (equivalent to $900,000,000 in 2025), the largest sum he had ever raised from selling some of his Amazon stock. On August 4, 2016, Bezos sold another million of his shares for $756 million (equivalent to $1,000,000,000 in 2025). A year later, Bezos took on 130,000 new employees when he ramped up hiring at company distribution centers. By January 19, 2018, his Amazon stock holdings had appreciated to slightly over $109 billion (equivalent to $140,000,000,000 in 2025); months later he began to sell stock to raise cash for other enterprises, in particular, Blue Origin. On January 29, 2018, he was featured in Amazon's Super Bowl commercial. On February 1, 2018, Amazon reported its highest ever profit with quarterly earnings of $2 billion (equivalent to $2,600,000,000 in 2025). Due to the growth of Alibaba in China, Bezos has often expressed interest in expanding Amazon into India. On July 27, 2017, Bezos momentarily became the world's wealthiest person over Microsoft co-founder Bill Gates when his estimated net worth increased to just over $90 billion (equivalent to $118,000,000,000 in 2025). His wealth surpassed $100 billion for the first time on November 24, 2017 (equivalent to $131,000,000,000 in 2025), and he was formally designated the wealthiest person in the world by Forbes on March 6, 2018, with a net worth of $112 billion (equivalent to $144,000,000,000 in 2025). In March 2018, Bezos dispatched Amit Agarwal, Amazon's global senior vice president, to India with $5.5 billion (equivalent to $7,100,000,000 in 2025) to localize operations throughout the company's supply chain routes. Later in the month, U.S. President Donald Trump accused Amazon and Bezos, specifically, of sales tax avoidance, misusing postal routes, and anti-competitive business practices. Amazon's share price fell by 9% in response to the President's negative comments; this reduced Bezos's personal wealth by $10.7 billion (equivalent to $13,700,000,000 in 2025). Weeks later, Bezos recouped his losses when academic reports out of Stanford University indicated that Trump could do little to regulate Amazon in any meaningful way. During July 2018, a number of members of the U.S. Congress called on Bezos to detail the applications of Amazon's face recognition software, Rekognition. Criticism of Amazon's business practices continued in September 2018 when Senator Bernie Sanders introduced the Stop Bad Employers by Zeroing Out Subsidies (Stop BEZOS) Act and accused Amazon of receiving corporate welfare. This followed revelations by the non-profit group New Food Economy which found that one third of Amazon workers in Arizona, and one tenth of Amazon workers in Pennsylvania and Ohio, relied on food stamps. While preparing to introduce the bill, Sanders opined: "Instead of attempting to explore Mars or go to the moon, how about Jeff Bezos pays his workers a living wage?" He later said: "Bezos could play a profound role. If he said today, nobody who is employed at Amazon will receive less than a living wage, it would send a message to every corporation in America." Sanders's efforts elicited a response from Amazon which pointed to the 130,000 jobs it created in 2017 and called the $28,446 figure (equivalent to $37,000 in 2025) for its median salary "misleading" as it included part-time workers. However, Sanders countered that the companies targeted by his proposal have placed an increased focus on part-time workers to escape benefit obligations. On October 2, 2018, Bezos announced a company-wide wage increase, which Sanders applauded. The American workers who were being paid the minimum wage had this increased to $15 per hour (equivalent to $19 in 2025), a decision that was interpreted as support for the Fight for $15 movement. In February 2021, Bezos announced that in the third quarter of 2021 he would step down from his role as CEO of Amazon to become the Executive Chairman of the Amazon Board. He was succeeded as CEO by Andy Jassy. On February 2, 2021, Bezos sent an email to all Amazon employees, telling them the transition would give him "the time and energy [he] need[s] to focus on the Day 1 Fund, the Bezos Earth Fund, Blue Origin, The Washington Post, and [his] other passions." In February 2024, Bezos sold 24 million shares in Amazon at a total value of $4 billion. Bezos announced that he intended to sell 50 million shares in Amazon over the next year. During an interview at the DealBook Summit in December 2024, Bezos said that he was dedicating 95% of his time to artificial intelligence initiatives at Amazon.

## Blue Origin

In September 2000, Bezos founded Blue Origin, a human spaceflight startup. Bezos has long expressed an interest in space travel and the development of human life in the Solar System. His 1982 high school valedictorian senior graduation speech was followed up with a Miami Herald interview in which he expressed an interest to build and develop hotels, amusement parks, and colonies for human beings who were in orbit. The 18-year-old Bezos stated that he wanted to preserve Earth from overuse through resource depletion. Rob Meyerson led Blue Origin from 2003 to 2017 and served as its first president. After its founding, Blue Origin maintained a low profile until 2006 when it purchased a large tract of land in West Texas for a launch and test facility. After the company gained the public's attention during the late 2000s, Bezos additionally indicated his interest in reducing the cost of space travel for humans while also increasing the safety of extraterrestrial travel. In September 2011, one of the company's uncrewed prototype vehicles crashed during a short-hop test flight. Although the crash was viewed as a setback, news outlets noted how far the company went from its founding-to-date in advancing spaceflight. After the crash, Bezos has been superstitiously wearing his "lucky" Texas Cowboy boots to all rocket launches. In May 2013, Bezos met with Richard Branson, chairman of Virgin Galactic, to discuss commercial spaceflight opportunities and strategies. He has been compared to Branson and Elon Musk as all three are billionaires who prioritize spaceflight among their business interests. In 2015, Bezos announced that a new orbital launch vehicle was under development and would make its first flight in the late-2010s. Later in November, Blue Origin's New Shepard space vehicle successfully rocketed into space and reached its planned test altitude of 329,839 feet (100.5 kilometers) before executing a vertical landing back at the launch site in West Texas. In 2016, Bezos allowed select journalists to visit, tour, and photograph his facility. He has repeatedly called for increased inter-space energy and industrial manufacturing to decrease the negative costs associated with business-related pollution. In December 2017, New Shepard successfully flew and landed dummy passengers, amending and pushing its human space travel start date into late 2018. To execute this program, Blue Origin built six of the vehicles to support all phases of testing and operations: no-passenger test flights, flights with test passengers, and commercial-passenger weekly operations. Since 2016, Bezos has spoken more freely about his hopes to colonize the solar system, and has been selling $1 billion in Amazon stock each year to capitalize Blue Origin in an effort to support this endeavor. In May 2018, Bezos maintained that the primary goal of Blue Origin is to preserve the natural resources of Earth by making the human species multi-planetary. He announced that New Shepard would begin transporting humans into sub-orbital space by November 2018. In July 2018, it was announced that Bezos had priced commercial spaceflight tickets from $200,000 to $300,000 per person.

## The Washington Post

On August 5, 2013, Bezos announced his purchase of The Washington Post for $250 million in cash (equivalent to $350,000,000 in 2025), at the suggestion of his friend, Don Graham. To execute the purchase, he established limited liability company Nash Holdings to serve as a holding company through which he would own the newspaper. The sale closed on October 1, 2013, and Nash Holdings took control. In March 2014, Bezos made his first significant change at The Washington Post and lifted the online paywall for subscribers of a number of U.S. local newspapers in Texas, Hawaii, and Minnesota. In January 2016, Bezos set out to reinvent the newspaper as a media and technology company by rebuilding its digital media, mobile platforms, and analytics software. After a surge in online readership in 2016, the paper was profitable for the first time since Bezos made the purchase in 2013. Bezos' ownership of the Post has been subject to scrutiny and criticism regarding his treatment of employees as well as his influence on the paper's content, particularly his 2024–25 involvement with the editorial and opinion pages. Throughout his early years of ownership of The Washington Post, Bezos was accused of having a potential conflict of interest with the paper. Bezos and the newspaper's editorial board have dismissed accusations that he unfairly controlled the paper's content, and Bezos maintains that the paper is independent. Bezos' treatment of employees at The Washington Post has also drawn scrutiny. In 2018, more than 400 Washington Post employees wrote an open letter to Bezos criticizing the wages and benefits provided to employees. The letter demanded "Fair wages; fair benefits for retirement, family leave and health care; and a fair amount of job security". About 750 employees at The Washington Post went on a brief strike in December 2023 in response to Bezos' plans to lay off staff. In 2024, Bezos blocked the Washington Post's editorial board from endorsing Kamala Harris in the presidential election. The move was criticized by former editor Marty Baron, who considered it to be an act of "disturbing spinelessness at an institution famed for courage" and said that it would invite intimidation of Bezos by Donald Trump. Editor-at-large Robert Kagan and columnist Michele Norris also resigned in the wake of the decision, and editor David Maraniss said that the paper was "dying in darkness". Post opinion columnists jointly authored an article calling the decision to not endorse a "terrible mistake", and it was condemned by the Washington Post Guild, a union unit representing Post employees. More than 250,000 people (about ten percent of the Post's subscribers) cancelled their subscriptions, and three members of the editorial board left it. In February 2025, Bezos announced that the opinion section of the Post will give voice to opinions that support "personal liberties" and "free markets". David Shipley, The Post's opinion editor, resigned after trying to persuade Bezos to reconsider the new direction. Within two days of the announcement, it was reported that over 75,000 digital subscribers had canceled their subscriptions. Due to his considerable influence on industry, politics, and media, Bezos has been described as an oligarch.

## Bezos Expeditions

Bezos makes personal investments through his venture capital vehicle, Bezos Expeditions. He was one of the first shareholders in Google, when he invested $250,000 in 1998 (equivalent to $490,000 in 2025). That $250,000 investment resulted in 3.3 million shares of Google stock, worth about $3.1 billion in 2017 (equivalent to $4,100,000,000 in 2025). He also invested in Unity Biotechnology, a life-extension research firm hoping to slow or stop the process of aging. Bezos is involved in the healthcare sector, which includes investments in Unity Biotechnology, GRAIL, Juno Therapeutics, and Zocdoc. In January 2018, an announcement was made concerning Bezos's role within a new, unnamed healthcare company. This venture, later named Haven, is expected to be a partnership between Amazon, JPMorgan, and Berkshire Hathaway. Bezos also supports philanthropic efforts through direct donations and non-profit projects funded by Bezos Expeditions. Bezos used Bezos Expeditions to fund several philanthropic projects, including an Innovation center at the Seattle Museum of History and Industry and the Bezos Center for Neural Circuit Dynamics at Princeton Neuroscience Institute. In 2013, Bezos Expeditions funded the recovery of two Saturn V first-stage Rocketdyne F-1 engines from the floor of the Atlantic Ocean. They were positively identified as belonging to the Apollo 11 mission's S-1C stage from July 1969. The engines are currently on display at the Seattle Museum of Flight. In September 2021, Bezos invested in biotechnology research company Altos Labs.

## Project Prometheus

In November 2025, Bezos announced that he co-founded Project Prometheus with former Google executive Vik Bajaj. The company will focus on the use of artificial intelligence in engineering and the manufacturing of computers, spacecraft, and automobiles.

## Public image

Journalist Nellie Bowles of The New York Times has described the public persona and personality of Bezos as that of "a brilliant but mysterious and coldblooded corporate titan". During the 1990s, Bezos earned a reputation for relentlessly pushing Amazon forward, often at the expense of public charity and social welfare. Journalist Mark O'Connell criticized Bezos's relentless customer focus as "very small" in terms of impact on humanity as a whole, a sentiment technologist Tim O'Reilly agreed with. His business practices projected a public image of prudence and parsimony with his own wealth and that of Amazon. Throughout the early 2000s, he was perceived to be geeky or nerdy. Bezos was seen by some as needlessly quantitative and data-driven. This perception was detailed by Alan Deutschman, who described him as "talking in lists" and "[enumerating] the criteria, in order of importance, for every decision he has made". Select accounts of his persona have drawn controversy and public attention. Notably, journalist Brad Stone wrote a book that described Bezos as a demanding boss as well as hyper-competitive, and opined that Bezos perhaps "bet the biggest on the Internet" out of anyone. Bezos has been characterized as a notoriously opportunistic CEO who operates with little concern for obstacles and externalities. During the early 2010s, Bezos solidified his reputation for aggressive business practices, and his public image began to shift. Bezos started to wear tailored clothing; he weight trained, pursued a regimented diet and began to freely spend his money. His physical transformation has been compared to the transformation of Amazon; he is often referred to as the metonym of the company. Since 2017, he has been portrayed by Kyle Mooney and Steve Carell on Saturday Night Live, usually as an undercutting, domineering figure. His physical appearance increased the public's perception of him as a symbolically dominant figure in business and in popular culture, wherein he has been parodied as an enterprising supervillain. In May 2014, the International Trade Union Confederation named Bezos the "World's Worst Boss", with its general secretary Sharan Burrow saying: "Jeff Bezos represents the inhumanity of employers who are promoting the North American corporate model", while in 2019, Harvard Business Review, which ranked Bezos the best-performing CEO for 4 years in a row since 2014, did not rank him even in the top 100, citing Amazon's "relatively low ESG (environment, social, and governance) scores" that reflect "risks created by working conditions and employment policies, data security, and antitrust issues". During the late 2010s, Bezos reversed his reputation for being reluctant to spend money on non-business-related expenses. His relative lack of philanthropy compared to other billionaires has drawn a negative response from the public since 2016. Bezos has been known to publicly contest claims made in critical articles, as exemplified in 2015 when he sent a memo to employees denouncing a New York Times piece.

## Leadership style

Bezos used what he called a "regret-minimization framework" while working at D. E. Shaw and again during the early years of Amazon. He described this life philosophy by stating: "When I'm 80, am I going to regret leaving Wall Street? No. Will I regret missing the beginning of the Internet? Yes." During the 1990s and early 2000s at Amazon, he was characterized as trying to quantify all aspects of running the company, often listing employees on spreadsheets and basing executive decisions on data. To push Amazon forward, Bezos developed the mantra "Get Big Fast", establishing the company's need to scale its operations to produce market dominance. He favored diverting Amazon profits back into the company in lieu of allocating it amongst shareholders in the form of dividends. Bezos uses the term "work–life harmony" instead of the more standard "work–life balance" because he believes that balance implies that you can only have one and not the other. He believes that work and home life are interconnected, informing and calibrating each other. Journalist Walt Mossberg dubbed the idea that someone who cannot tolerate criticism or critique should not do anything new or interesting "The Bezos Principle". Bezos does not schedule early morning meetings and enforces a two-pizza rule—a preference that meetings are small enough for two pizzas to feed everyone in the boardroom. When interviewing candidates for jobs at Amazon, he has stated he considers three inquiries: can he admire the person, can the person raise the common standard, and under what circumstances could the person become exemplary. In 2018, it was reported that he met with Amazon investors for just six hours a year. Instead of using presentation slides, Bezos requires high-level employees to present information with six-page narratives. Since 1998, Bezos has published an annual letter for Amazon shareholders wherein he frequently refers to five principles: focus on customers, not competitors; take risks for market leadership; facilitate staff morale; build a company culture; and empower people. Bezos maintains the email address jeff@amazon.com as an outlet for customers to reach out to him and the company. Although he does not respond to the emails, he forwards some of them with a question mark in the subject line to executives, who then attempt to address the issues. Bezos has cited Jeff Immelt of New Enterprise Associates, Warren Buffett of Berkshire Hathaway, Jamie Dimon of JPMorgan Chase, and Bob Iger of The Walt Disney Company as major influences on his leadership style.

## Recognition

In 1999, Bezos received his first major award when Time named him Person of the Year. In 2008, he was selected by U.S. News & World Report as one of America's best leaders. Bezos was awarded an honorary doctorate in science and technology from Carnegie Mellon University in 2008. In 2011, The Economist gave Bezos and Gregg Zehr an Innovation Award for the Amazon

Kindle. In 2012, Bezos was named Businessperson of the Year by Fortune. He is also a member of the Bilderberg Group and attended the 2011 Bilderberg conference in St. Moritz, Switzerland, and the 2013 conference in Watford, Hertfordshire, England. He was a member of the executive committee of The Business Council for 2011 and 2012, and appointed as chairman of the organization in 2014. Between 2014 and 2018, he was ranked the best-performing CEO in the world by Harvard Business Review. He has also figured in Fortune's list of 50 great leaders of the world for three straight years, topping the list in 2015. In September 2016, Bezos received a $250,000 prize for winning the Heinlein Prize for Advances in Space Commercialization, which he donated to the Students for the Exploration and Development of Space. In February 2018, Bezos was elected to the National Academy of Engineering for "leadership and innovation in space exploration, autonomous systems, and building a commercial pathway for human space flight". In March 2018, at the Explorers Club annual dinner, he was awarded the Buzz Aldrin Space Exploration Award in recognition of his work with Blue Origin. He received Germany's 2018 Axel Springer Award for Business Innovation and Social Responsibility. Time magazine named him one of the 100 most influential people in the world on five separate occasions between 2008 and 2018. In 2019, Bezos was inducted into the Living Legends of Aviation, being awarded with the Jeff Bezos Freedom's Wings Award and the Kenn Ricci Lifetime Aviation Entrepreneur Award. In February 2023, Bezos was presented with the Légion d'honneur, the highest French order of merit. Bezos had been designated a member of the Légion d'Honneur about 10 years earlier but was not available to collect it.

## Wealth

Bezos first became a millionaire in 1997 after raising $54 million (equivalent to $110,000,000 in 2025) through Amazon's initial public offering (IPO). He was first included on the Forbes World's Billionaires list in 1999 with an estimated net worth of $10.1 billion (equivalent to $19,500,000,000 in 2025), which placed his on the 19th position in the world and 10th in the USA. His net worth decreased to $6.1 billion a year later (equivalent to $11,400,000,000 in 2025), a 40.5% drop. His wealth plummeted even more the following year, dropping 66.6% to $2.0 billion (equivalent to $3,600,000,000 in 2025). He lost $500 million the following year (equivalent to $900,000,000 in 2025), which brought his net worth down to $1.5 billion (equivalent to $2,700,000,000 in 2025). The following year, his net worth increased by 66.66% to $2.5 billion (equivalent to $4,400,000,000 in 2025). From 2005 to 2007, he quadrupled his net worth to $8.7 billion (equivalent to $14,300,000,000 in 2025). After the 2008 financial crisis and Great Recession, his net worth would decrease to $6.8 billion (equivalent to $10,200,000,000 in 2025)—a 17.7% drop. His wealth rose by 85.2% in 2010, leaving him with $12.6 billion (equivalent to $18,600,000,000 in 2025). This percentage increase ascended him to the 43rd spot on the ranking from 68th. After a rumor broke out that Amazon was developing a smartphone, Bezos's net worth rose to $30.5 billion in 2014 (equivalent to $41,500,000,000 in 2025). A year later, he entered the top ten when he increased his net worth to a total of $50.3 billion (equivalent to $68,300,000,000 in 2025).

Bezos rose to become the fifth richest person in the world hours before market close; he gained $7 billion in one hour (equivalent to $9,000,000,000 in 2025). By the time the Forbes list was calculated in March 2016, his net worth was registered at $45.2 billion (equivalent to $60,600,000,000 in 2025). However, just months later in October 2016, his wealth increased by $16.2 billion (equivalent to $21,700,000,000 in 2025) to $66.5 billion (equivalent to $89,200,000,000 in 2025), unofficially ranking him the third-richest person in the world, behind Warren Buffett. After sporadic jumps in Amazon's share price, in July 2017 he briefly unseated Microsoft co-founder Bill Gates as the wealthiest person in the world. Bezos would continue to sporadically surpass Gates throughout the month of October 2017 after Amazon's share price fluctuated. His net worth surpassed $100 billion for the first time on November 24, 2017 (equivalent to $131,000,000,000 in 2025), after Amazon's share price increased by more than 2.5%. When the 2017 list was issued, Bezos's net worth was registered at $72.8 billion (equivalent to $95,620,418,137 in 2025), adding $27.6 billion from the previous year (equivalent to $36,000,000,000 in 2025). His wealth's rapid growth from 2016 to 2017 sparked a variety of assessments about how much money Bezos earned on a controlled, reduced time scale. On October 10, 2017, he made an estimated $6.24 billion (equivalent to $8,200,000,000 in 2025) in 5 minutes, slightly less than the then annual gross domestic product of Kyrgyzstan. On March 6, 2018, Bezos was designated the wealthiest person in the world, with a registered net worth of $112 billion (equivalent to $144,000,000,000 in 2025). He unseated Bill Gates ($90 billion, equivalent to $115,000,000,000 in 2025), who was $6 billion (equivalent to $7,700,000,000 in 2025) ahead of Warren Buffett ($84 billion, equivalent to $108,000,000,000 in 2025), ranked third. He is considered the first registered centi-billionaire (not adjusted for inflation). Bezos's net worth increased by $33.6 billion (equivalent to $44,000,000,000 in 2025) from January 2017 to January 2018. Following a report by Quartz highlighting Bezos' wealth, Amazon workers in Poland, Germany, and Spain participated in demonstrations and labor strikes draw attention to his growing wealth and the lack of compensation, labor rights, and satisfactory working conditions of select Amazon workers. On July 17, 2018, he was designated the "wealthiest person in modern history" by the Bloomberg Billionaires Index, Fortune, MarketWatch, The Wall Street Journal, and Forbes. In 2019, Bezos's wealth was reduced by the divorce from his wife MacKenzie Bezos. According to Forbes, had the Washington state common law applied to their divorce without a prenuptial agreement, Bezos's wealth could have been equitably divided with his ex-wife; however, she eventually received 25% of Bezos's Amazon shares, then valued at approximately $36 billion (equivalent to $45,000,000,000 in 2025), making her the third-richest woman in the world. Bezos retained his interest in The Washington Post and Blue Origin, as well as voting control of the shares received by his ex-wife. In June 2019, Bezos purchased three adjoining apartments overlooking Madison Square Park in Manhattan, including a penthouse, for a combined total of $80 million (equivalent to $101,000,000 in 2025), making this one of the most expensive real estate purchases within New York City in 2019. Bezos had also purchased three adjoining apartments at 25 Central Park West in Manhattan for $7.65 million in 1999 (equivalent to $14,800,000 in 2025); he bought a fourth unit in that building for $5.3 million in 2012 (equivalent to

$7,400,000 in 2025). In February 2020, Bezos purchased the Warner Estate from David Geffen for $165 million (equivalent to $205,000,000 in 2025), a record price paid for a residence in the Los Angeles area. During the COVID-19 pandemic, it was reported that Bezos's fortune had grown by $24 billion (equivalent to $29,900,000,000 in 2025), citing a surge in demand from households on lockdown shopping on Amazon. He further expanded his residential holdings in February 2022, purchasing a $16.1 million apartment at a 24-story boutique condominium (equivalent to $17,700,000 in 2025), located across from Madison Square Park in the Flatiron neighborhood, where he already owns all the units on the top floor. Bezos is the owner of the Y721, a luxury superyacht estimated to cost more than $500,000,000 (equivalent to $550,000,000 in 2025); it is the largest yacht in the world. According to Forbes Bezos was the second-wealthiest person in America and the third-wealthiest person in the world in 2023. Bezos added a remote 14-acre estate on La Perouse Bay in Maui, encircled by inactive lava fields, to his real estate holdings for $78 million in 2022 (equivalent to $90,000,000 in 2025). As of May 2026, the Bloomberg Billionaires Index ranks Bezos the fourth wealthiest person in the world, with an estimated wealth of $279 billion.

## Personal life

In 1992, while working for D. E. Shaw in Manhattan, Bezos met novelist MacKenzie Tuttle, who was a research associate at the firm; the couple married a year later. In 1994, they moved across the country to Seattle, Washington, where Bezos founded Amazon. Bezos and his ex-wife MacKenzie are the parents of four children: three sons, and a daughter adopted from China. In March 2003, Bezos was a passenger in a helicopter that crashed in West Texas while surveying land to buy for Blue Origin; the other three occupants in the helicopter were pilot Charles "Cheater" Bella, Amazon lawyer Elizabeth Korrell, and local rancher Ty Holland. All survived; Bezos sustained only minor injuries and was discharged from a local hospital the same day. Bezos portrayed a Starfleet official in the 2016 movie Star Trek Beyond, and joined the cast and crew at a San Diego Comic-Con screening. He had lobbied Paramount for the role apropos of Alexa and his personal/professional interest in speech recognition. His one line consisted of a response to an alien in distress: "Speak Normally." In his initial discussion of the project which became Alexa with his technical advisor Greg Hart in 2011, Bezos told him that the goal was to create "the Star Trek computer." Bezos's family corporation Zefram LLC is named after Zefram Cochrane, a character from Star Trek. In January 2019, Bezos and his wife MacKenzie released a joint statement which revealed that they would be getting divorced after 25 years together. Subsequently, National Enquirer revealed that Bezos had an affair with media personality Lauren Sánchez; the affair with Sánchez had lasted for months. Later, Bezos published an online essay on February 7, 2019, in which he accused American Media, Inc. owner David Pecker of "extortion and blackmail" for threatening to publish intimate photos of Bezos and current girlfriend Lauren Sánchez if he did not stop his investigation into how his text messages and other photos had been leaked to the National Enquirer. Media reports have accused Sánchez's brother Michael of being the source for the photos obtained by National Enquirer; however, Bezos has speculated that it may have been the Saudi Arabian government. On April 4, 2019, the divorce was finalized, with Bezos keeping 75% of the couple's Amazon stock and MacKenzie getting the remaining 25% ($35.6 billion, equivalent to $44,800,000,000 in 2025). However, Bezos would keep all of the couple's voting rights. Sánchez and Bezos became engaged in May 2023. The couple married in Venice on June 27, 2025, with the ceremony attracting mainstream media attention and various celebrities. Bezos is the Honorary Chair of the Explorers Club.

## Politics

According to public campaign finance records, Bezos supported the electoral campaigns of Patty Murray and Maria Cantwell, two Democratic U.S. senators from Washington. He has also supported Democrats U.S. representative John Conyers, as well as Patrick Leahy and Republican Spencer Abraham, U.S. senators serving on committees dealing with Internet-related issues. Jeff Bezos and MacKenzie Bezos have supported the legalization of same-sex marriage, and in 2012 contributed $2.5 million (equivalent to $3,500,000 in 2025) to Washington United for Marriage, a group supporting a yes vote on Washington Referendum 74, which affirmed a same-sex marriage law enacted in the state. Bezos donated $100,000 (equivalent to $150,000 in 2025) towards a movement against a Washington state income tax in 2010 for "top earners". In 2012, he donated to Amazon's political action committee (PAC), which has given $56,000 (equivalent to $79,000 in 2025) and $74,500 (equivalent to $104,000 in 2025) to Democrats and Republicans, respectively. In 2014, Amazon won a bid for a cloud computing contract with the CIA valued at $600 million (equivalent to $800,000,000 in 2025). A 2018, $10 billion contract (equivalent to $12,800,000,000 in 2025) known as the Joint Enterprise Defense Infrastructure (JEDI) project, this time with the Pentagon, was allegedly written up in a way that favors Amazon. Controversy over this was raised when General James Mattis accepted a headquarters tour invitation from Bezos and coordinated the deal through Sally Donnelly, a lobbyist who previously worked for Amazon. In November 2019, when the contract was awarded to Microsoft instead, Amazon filed a lawsuit with allegations that the bidding process was biased. On July 6, 2021, the Pentagon cancelled the JEDI contract with Microsoft, citing that "due to evolving requirements, increased cloud conversancy, and industry advances, the JEDI Cloud contract no longer meets its needs." Despite Bezos's support for an open borders policy towards immigrants, Amazon has actively marketed facial recognition software to U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement (ICE). In 2019, a PAC linked to Bezos spent over $1 million (equivalent to $1,300,000 in 2025) in an unsuccessful attempt to defeat the reelection bid of Seattle city council member and activist Kshama Sawant. On November 22, 2021, Jeff Bezos donated $100 million (equivalent to $119,000,000 in 2025) to the Obama Foundation to "help expand the scope of programming that reaches emerging leaders" and requested the Obama Presidential Center's plaza to be named after John Lewis.

## Donald Trump

After the 2016 presidential election, Bezos was invited to join Donald Trump's Defense Innovation Advisory Board, an advisory council to improve the technology used by the Defense Department. Trump has repeatedly criticized Bezos via Twitter, accused Bezos of avoiding corporate taxes, gaining undue political influence, and undermining his presidency by spreading fake news. Nevertheless, Bezos congratulated Trump on his second election victory, posting on X, "Big congratulations to our 45th and now 47th President on an extraordinary political comeback and decisive victory. No nation has bigger opportunities. Wishing Donald Trump all success in leading and uniting the America we all love." Since 2023, Bezos has been a resident of Indian Creek, Florida. As reported by Axios in February 2025, Bezos held a private phone conversation in July 2024 with then-candidate Trump, planting the seeds of a "Bezos–Trump alliance" months before Bezos blocked the Washington Post's editorial board from endorsing Kamala Harris in the election. After Trump's November victory, Bezos dined with Elon Musk and Trump at Mar-a-Lago; Amazon subsequently donated $1 million to Trump's inauguration, at which Bezos was in attendance. Bezos and Trump were reported to have met for dinner again in February 2025, on the same night that Bezos announced changes to the Washington Post's opinion policies to promote "free markets and personal liberties" and suppress divergent opinions. Axios characterized it as "another sign of Trump and Bezos' growing closeness". According to the Financial Times, Bezos had a contentious relationship with Trump during Trump's first term, but worked to have a positive relationship with Trump in 2024 and during Trump's second term. Bezos reportedly supported Trump to further his business interests, and supports many of Trump's policies. The Financial Times also noted that Bezos had made other changes in his life, including stepping down as CEO of Amazon in 2021, focusing on Blue Origin, and being engaged to Lauren Sánchez, which may have changed his political views.

## Saudi hacking claim

In March 2018, Bezos met in Seattle with Mohammad bin Salman, the crown prince and de facto ruler of Saudi Arabia, to discuss investment opportunities for Saudi Vision 2030. In March 2019, Bezos's security consultant accused the Saudi government of hacking Bezos's phone. According to BBC, Bezos's top security staffer, Gavin de Becker, "linked the hack to the Washington Post's coverage of the murder of Saudi writer Jamal Khashoggi at the Saudi consulate in Istanbul". Khashoggi, a Saudi journalist and dissident, was employed as a writer at the Washington Post, owned by Bezos. Khashoggi was killed in late 2018 in Turkey's Saudi consulate for his critical stance and journalism against the Saudi government and its leader. In January 2020, The Guardian reported that the hack was initiated before the murder but after Khashoggi wrote critically about the crown prince in the Washington Post. Forensic analysis of Bezos's mobile phone conducted by advisory firm FTI Consulting, concluded it "highly probable" that the hack was achieved using a malicious file hidden in a video sent in a WhatsApp message to Bezos from the personal account of the crown prince on May 1, 2018. Saudi Arabia has denied the claim.

## Philanthropy

Bezos donated to the Fred Hutchinson Cancer Research Center several times between 2009 and 2017. In 2013, he pledged $500,000 (equivalent to $700,000 in 2025) to Worldreader, a non-profit founded by a former Amazon employee. In September 2018, Business Insider reported that Bezos was the only one of the top five billionaires in the world who had not signed the Giving Pledge, an initiative created by Bill Gates and Warren Buffett that encourages wealthy people to give away a majority of their wealth. That same month, Janet Camarena, director of transparency initiatives at Foundation Center, was quoted by CNBC as having questions about Bezos's new Day 1 Fund, including the fund's structure and how exactly it will be funded. In May 2017, Bezos gave $1 million (equivalent to $1,300,000 in 2025) to the Reporters Committee for Freedom of the Press, which provides pro bono legal services for American journalists. On June 15, 2017, he posted a message on Twitter asking for ideas for philanthropy: "I'm thinking about a philanthropy strategy that is the opposite of how I mostly spend my time—working on the long term". At the time of the post, Bezos's lifetime spending on charitable causes was estimated to be $100 million (equivalent to $130,000,000 in 2025). Multiple opinion columnists responded by asking Bezos to pay higher wages to Amazon warehouse workers. A year later in June, he tweeted that he would announce two philanthropic foci by the end of summer 2018. Bezos announced in September 2018 that he would commit approximately $2 billion (equivalent to $2,600,000,000 in 2025) to a fund to deal with American homelessness and establish a network of non-profit preschools for low-income communities. As part of this announcement, he committed to establishing the "Day 1 Families Fund" to finance "night shelters and day care centers for homeless families" and the "Day 1 Academies Fund" for early childhood education. In January 2018, Bezos made a $33 million donation (equivalent to $42,000,000 in 2025) to TheDream.US, a college scholarship fund for undocumented immigrants brought to the United States as minors. In June 2018, Bezos donated to Breakthrough Energy Ventures, a private philanthropic fund founded by Bill Gates aimed at promoting emissions-free energy. In September 2018, Bezos donated $10 million (equivalent to $13,000,000 in 2025) to With Honor, a nonpartisan organization that works to increase the number of veterans in political office. In February 2020, Bezos pledged $10 billion (equivalent to $12,400,000,000 in 2025) to combat climate change through the Bezos Earth Fund. Later that year, in November, Bezos announced $791 million (equivalent to $980,000,000 in 2025) of donations to established, well-known groups, with $100 million (equivalent to $120,000,000 in 2025) each going to Environmental Defense Fund, Natural Resources Defense Council, The Nature Conservancy, World Resources Institute and World Wildlife Fund, and the remainder going to 11 other groups. In April 2020, early in the COVID-19 pandemic, Bezos donated $100 million (equivalent to $120,000,000 in 2025) to food banks through Feeding America. In November 2021, Bezos pledged to donate $2 billion (equivalent to $2,400,000,000 in 2025) towards restructuring food systems and nature conservation at the 2021 United Nations Climate Change Conference. The Earth Fund supported the Earth Rover Program, which aims to develop high-yield low-environmental-impact farming by novel seismological study of soils, with

$4m. In July 2021, Bezos announced the Courage and Civility Award and donated $100 million (equivalent to $120,000,000 in 2025) each to lawyer Van Jones and chef José Andrés. The next year, he donated $100 million (equivalent to $110,000,000 in 2025) to singer Dolly Parton in recognition of her charity work focused on improving children's literacy around the world. In March 2024, he donated $50 million (equivalent to $55,000,000 in 2025) each to actress Eva Longoria and retired admiral Bill McRaven. Bezos Academy is a group of tuition-free preschools for students from low-income families, which was created by Bezos, and which operate in a manner similar to the Montessori method (but are not accredited as Montessori schools). On November 22, 2022, Bezos awarded $123 million (equivalent to $140,000,000 in 2025) to organizations that are engaged in relocating homeless families to permanent housing. Day 1 Families Fund grants, the amounts of which vary in monetary terms, will be sent to 40 organizations across the country.

## See also

List of Princeton University alumni List of richest Americans in history

## Sources

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## External links

Jeff Bezos at TED Appearances on C-SPAN Jeff Bezos on Charlie Rose Jeff Bezos collected news and commentary at The New York Times Forbes Profile

# Chapter 4

## Recent Developments and Current Work

### Elon Musk Says ‘Sadly, Yes’ Jeff Bezos’ Ex-Wife MacKenzie Scott Has Donated Over $26 Billion — And It’s Making the World Worse - Yahoo

Yahoo | 2026-07-11

Benzinga and Yahoo Finance LLC may earn commission or revenue on some items through the links below. Good intentions don't always earn universal applause. Sometimes they earn a two-word reply instead. Tesla and SpaceX CEO Elon Musk — and richest man in the world — offered exactly that after responding to an X post highlighting Amazon founder Jeff Bezos' ex-wife and philanthropist MacKenzie Scott's charitable giving. The original post said that Scott had donated more than $26.3 billion to charity, making her one of the biggest individual donors in history, and that she wanted to spend most of her Bezos fortune "on helping others and making the world a better place." Apple Thinks Spatial Computing Is The Future. This Private Company Is Building The Workplace To Match. The AI Gold Rush Needs Picks And Shovels Too — This Company Is Building The Infrastructure Layer. Another X user replied , "Unfortunately, she's spending it making the world a worse place." Scott has become one of the most prolific philanthropists in history since her 2019 divorce from Bezos. Her philanthropic organization Yield Giving has awarded more than $26 billion to thousands of nonprofits, primarily through unrestricted grants that allow organizations to decide how the money is used. Critics argue many of the grants have gone to organizations focused on progressive causes, including racial equity, immigration, climate initiatives and LGBTQ+ advocacy. Musk didn't explain his brief reply, but it aligns with views he has shared publicly for years. Trending: If there was a new fund backed by Jeff Bezos offering a 7-9% target yield with monthly dividends would you invest in it? "If you care about the reality of goodness instead of the perception of it, then it is very hard to give away money effectively," Musk told TED curator Chris Anderson during an interview in 2022. He expanded on that idea during an appearance on the "WTF" podcast with entrepreneur Nikhil Kamath in 2025, saying philanthropy that creates measurable, lasting benefits is " extremely difficult " because donations can produce unintended consequences despite good intentions. Rather than emphasizing charitable giving, Musk has often pointed to building companies as his preferred way of creating lasting impact, arguing that businesses such as Tesla and SpaceX solve problems at a scale traditional philanthropy often cannot. For everyday people, accessible earning and investment models offer another path to build personal wealth that can support giving. Mode Mobile's EarnPhone turns everyday smartphone use—gaming, streaming, reading—into real earnings, with hundreds of millions already paid out to users worldwide. Retail investors can also participate directly via crowdfunding rounds, owning a piece of the company itself. See Also: Investors With $1M+ Often Use Advisors for Tax Strategy — This Tool Matches You With One in Minutes This creates a practical loop: earn more from daily habits, invest in scalable tech that empowers others, and potentially give more effectively—echoing Musk's focus on value creation over pure redistribution. Scott's supporters see a philanthropist moving enormous wealth into communities and organizations that need it most. Her critics believe the recipients of those donations matter just as much as the size of the checks. Whether lasting progress comes from funding nonprofits or building transformative companies is likely to remain a matter of opinion. But in just two words, Musk reminded millions that even the largest charitable gifts won't always receive universal praise. Read Next: The Wealthy Have Long Used Private Real Estate To Diversify Beyond Stocks. Here's One Platform Opening That Door. Building a resilient portfolio means thinking beyond a single asset or market trend. Economic cycles shift, sectors rise and fall, and no one investment performs well in every environment. That's why many investors look to diversify with platforms that provide access to real estate, fixed-income opportunities, precious metals, and even self-directed retirement accounts. By spreading exposure across multiple asset classes, it becomes easier to manage risk, capture steady returns, and create long-term wealth that isn't tied to the fortunes of just one company or industry. Backed by Jeff Bezos, Arrived Homes makes real estate investing accessible with a low barrier to entry. Investors can buy fractional shares of single-family rentals and vacation homes starting with as little as $100 . This allows everyday investors to diversify into real estate, collect rental income, and build long-term wealth without needing to manage properties directly. Farmland has historically held its value through market volatility and delivered returns uncorrelated to stocks and bonds. For accredited investors, FarmTogether offers direct access to high-quality U.S. farmland starting at $15,000 — fully managed, with no landlord headaches. Private real estate and private credit can add income and stability to a stock-heavy portfolio. Fundrise offers access to diversified private real estate and credit strategies through an easy-to-use platform, with professionally managed portfolios designed to generate passive income and long-term growth. Institutional-quality real estate has traditionally been difficult for individual investors to access. Realberry gives accredited investors direct access to private real estate opportunities backed by a team with 35 years of experience, $3.4 billion in assets under management, and $481 million in cumulative distributions paid to investors as of Q4 2025, according to the company. With a portfolio spanning 13 million square feet across seven U.S. states, Realberry focuses on acquiring, developing, and managing real estate with an emphasis on long-term value creation while its principals often invest alongside clients to help align interests. Immersed is building technology for the future of work through spatial computing. Known for its AR/VR productivity platform that enables users to work across multiple virtual screens, the company has grown to more than 1.5 million users worldwide. Immersed is also developing Visor, a lightweight headset designed specifically for professional productivity, positioning the company at the intersection of remote work, extended reality (XR), and next-generation computing. The rapid adoption of artificial intelligence is creating significant demand for data centers, power, and compute infrastructure. BluSky AI is building modular AI data centers designed to support next-generation AI workloads while aiming to reduce deployment timelines compared to traditional facilities. For investors looking beyond AI software and applications, the company offers exposure to the infrastructure layer that makes artificial intelligence possible. Fine wine and rare whiskey have historically moved independently of the stock market, making them a compelling alternative asset. Vinovest manages authenticated, insured portfolios of investment-grade wine and whiskey starting at $5,000 — sourcing, storage, and insurance all handled for you. For accredited investors looking beyond stocks and bonds, EquityMultiple provides access to vetted commercial real estate deals starting at $5,000 , with only ~5% of opportunities passing their due diligence process. Mode Mobile is changing the way people interact with their phones by letting users earn money from the same apps and activities they already use every day. Instead of platforms keeping all the advertising revenue, Mode Mobile shares a portion back with users who engage with content, play games, and scroll on their devices. Named one of Deloitte's fastest-growing software companies in North America, the company has built a large beta user base and is scaling a model that turns everyday smartphone usage into a potential income stream. This article Elon Musk Says 'Sadly, Yes' Jeff Bezos' Ex-Wife MacKenzie Scott Has Donated Over $26 Billion — And It's Making the World Worse originally appeared on Benzinga.com

## While Jeff Bezos was sitting in the passenger seat writing Amazon's business plan in 1994, his wife MacKe - The Times of India

The Times of India | 2026-07-12

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## Jeff Bezos' Blue Origin Scrapped Its Destroyed Launchpad and Plans to Return to Flight by December 2026 Using a New Hybrid Launch System. - Yahoo Finance

Yahoo Finance | 2026-07-14

Blue Origin's May 28 explosion of its reusable, heavy-lift New Glenn rocket was a serious setback. It destroyed the rocket and damaged the only operational launchpad for Blue Origin's heavy-lift rocket program. The company was trying to prove that its rocket could serve major customers, including Amazon 's (NASDAQ: AMZN) satellite internet network, NASA's Artemis lunar program, and U.S. national security missions. CEO Dave Limp expects New Glenn to return to flight before the end of 2026. However, Blue Origin is not just repairing the old setup. Instead, Blue Origin is moving to a new launch process that could help it recover more quickly. But the real test is whether it can fix the reliability problems and prove New Glenn can launch safely on a regular basis. Missed Nvidia in 2009? This Rare Signal Is Flashing Again. In 2009, a "Double Down" signal flashed for a little-known chipmaker called Nvidia. For the first time in years, that same "Total Conviction" signal is flashing for a company 1/100th the size of Nvidia. Continue » Although Blue Origin lost the lightning tower, transporter-erector, and hydraulic cylinders, several important parts of the launch site survived. The tank farm, integration facility, vehicle access tower, and water tower were still usable or repairable. That makes a full rebuild less likely and a 2026 return easier to believe. The bigger change is how New Glenn will launch. The company does not plan to replace the old transporter-erector used to move and raise the rocket at the launchpad. Instead, Blue Origin now plans to assemble the rocket in one area, move it to the pad, lift it upright with a crane, and then attach the customer's payload. The company says this approach was already planned for a larger future version of New Glenn. New Glenn is built for heavy satellite, government, and lunar missions. If Blue Origin can fix the reliability issues, the setback could still help push the company toward a stronger launch system. New Glenn's recovery matters because Blue Origin has real customers lined up. Amazon plans to use New Glenn for 12 Project Kuiper satellite launches, with options for 15 more. Amazon Leo had deployed around 400 satellites by early July 2026 and expects to begin initial service later in 2026. But with a planned 3,236-satellite network, Amazon still needs many more launches to build meaningful coverage and capacity. NASA has also contracted with Blue Origin for its second Artemis lunar lander contract. This has tied New Glenn's reliability to Blue Origin's moon plans. Reuters also reported that Blue Origin is seeking $10 billion in funding at a $130 billion valuation, with Jeff Bezos expected to add $2 billion. The money could help repair launch infrastructure and support New Glenn's return to flight, but investors will expect repeated, reliable launches. The biggest risk, however, is still reliability. Blue Origin said it was still investigating the May failure, but early signs pointed to the engine area at the bottom of the New Glenn rocket. New Glenn also had a problem in April with its upper rocket section, which left AST SpaceMobile 's BlueBird-7 satellite in the wrong orbit. Blue Origin was already coming off an April flight problem, after which the U.S. Federal Aviation Administration said nine corrective actions had to be verified before the next New Glenn launch. The May 28 ground-test explosion added a separate setback. So even if New Glenn returns to flight in December, Blue Origin will still need repeated safe launches to prove the rocket is reliable. 

Netflix: if you invested $1,000 when we doubled down in 2004, you'd have $395,679 !* Right now, we're issuing "Double Down" alerts for three incredible companies, available when you join Stock Advisor , and there may not be another chance like this anytime soon. Manali Pradhan, CFA has no position in any of the stocks mentioned. The Motley Fool has positions in and recommends AST SpaceMobile and Amazon. The Motley Fool has a disclosure policy . Jeff Bezos' Blue Origin Scrapped Its Destroyed Launchpad and Plans to Return to Flight by December 2026 Using a New Hybrid Launch System. was originally published by The Motley Fool

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Build a calm, realistic plan to recover from job loss and move toward your next role.

## Nuclear Fusion Isn’t Here Yet, But Now You Can Buy This Bezos-Backed Stock to Play It - Barron's

Barron's | 2026-07-13

Nuclear Fusion Isn’t Here Yet, But Now You Can Buy This Bezos-Backed Stock to Play It Barron's

## Lauren Sánchez Bezos revives the tied shirt trend in effortlessly chic summer look - HOLA

HOLA | 2026-07-13

Lauren Sánchez Bezos once again proved she knows how to turn even a business conference into a fashion moment. While attending the exclusive Allen & Company Sun Valley Conference, often nicknamed "billionaires' summer camp," in Idaho alongside husband Jeff Bezos, the former journalist embraced one of summer's biggest comeback trends, the tied button-down shirt. The invitation-only gathering attracts some of the world's most influential leaders in technology, media, finance, and entertainment every July. But alongside the business headlines, the conference has increasingly become an unexpected showcase for relaxed luxury style. For the occasion, Sánchez opted for a soft baby pink button-down shirt styled with the front tied into a knot, creating a cropped silhouette that revealed a hint of midriff while keeping the overall look polished. She paired the feminine top with a flowing low-rise midi skirt featuring an abstract black brushstroke print over a blush pink base. The movement of the skirt balanced the structured shirt, giving the outfit an elegant resort-inspired feel. Her accessories elevated the ensemble without overwhelming it. Sánchez completed the look with ivory platform stilettos, a structured white

Hermès Birkin bag, oversized diamond stud earrings and classic aviator sunglasses. She wore her brunette hair in a relaxed ponytail with loose face-framing waves, while her natural glam makeup focused on bronzed skin, softly defined eyes and a glossy nude lip. Jeff Bezos complemented her look in a simple black polo, blue jeans and black cowboy boots. The tied button-down has quietly become one of the defining styling tricks of Summer 2026. Rather than wearing an oversized shirt traditionally tucked into trousers or shorts, celebrities have embraced tying it at the waist to create a cropped effect that feels both polished and relaxed. Sydney Sweeney recently embraced the same styling technique during a summer outing, while Lori Harvey has also incorporated tied shirts into her warm-weather wardrobe, helping cement the look as one of the season's most wearable celebrity trends. The appeal lies in its versatility. A classic button-down instantly feels lighter and more vacation-ready when knotted at the waist, making it easy to pair with flowing skirts, linen trousers or denim while maintaining an effortlessly chic aesthetic. At one of the world's most exclusive gatherings, Sánchez demonstrated that even among billionaires and tech moguls, the simplest summer styling trick can make the biggest fashion statement.

## SpaceX and Amazon are tech doppelgangers worth $4.5 trillion—and they're headed for a collision - Fortune

Fortune | 2026-07-13

A charismatic founder with near-obsessive conviction, a business that bleeds money, and a stock price based on a wildly optimistic valuation. In 1997, Jeff Bezos took Amazon public at a price of $18 per share at a $438 million valuation. The online bookseller’s stock would then crater 90% after the dot-com bubble burst, before flourishing into a $2.6 trillion conglomerate that raked in $77.7 billion last year. Founded by Elon Musk, the company lost $4.9 billion last year, and went public at $135 a share in June, with a valuation that quickly rose to a sky-high $2 trillion. The two mega-cap companies are primarily known for businesses that have little in common, with Amazon dominating the online retail business while SpaceX has become the world’s leading rocket maker. But look a little closer, and the two companies have strikingly similar silhouettes which seem likely to bump up against each other ever more frequently as they compete on the public market stage. Perhaps more than any other tech companies out there today, Amazon and SpaceX are both conglomerates with broad collections of assets and businesses that each believe work together to create a more powerful whole. Both companies offer satellite-beamed high-speed internet access. They’re both in the cloud computing and AI infrastructure business with expensive data centers. Chips? Amazon’s Trainium and Graviton processors hit an annual revenue run rate above $20 billion in Q1, nearly doubling the $10 billion run rate from the previous quarter. SpaceX has a chip-manufacturing initiative called Terafab with a goal of producing one terawatt of compute hardware each year. Amazon and SpaceX each also have advertising platforms, with Amazon ginning up $68.6 billion in ad revenue last year while SpaceX’s X platform—the social media service formerly known as Twitter—lived inside the AI segment that posted a $6.4 billion operating loss. If you squint, you can see them as doppelgängers with one big difference—or to be more accurate, nearly 700 billion differences. Amazon hit $716.9 billion in revenue in 2025 and $80 billion in operating income compared to SpaceX's $18.7 billion of revenue and a $2.6 billion operating loss. Investors are focused on the opportunity ahead, of course. Amazon trades at roughly 3.6 times last year's sales and about 28 times forward earnings. SpaceX trades at about 97 times sales, and had a $4.9 billion net loss. "You're basically buying [SpaceX] at an Amazon valuation when it has one-twentieth the revenue of Amazon," said Jim Lebenthal, a veteran investor and chief markets strategist at Cerity Partners. "SpaceX is an incredibly cool company—it's amazing, everything they're doing. I also think it's wildly overvalued right now." Looking at the rival companies piece by piece, you can see that in nearly every competitive line of business, Amazon is more profitable and growing. But it was also the company that took a nosedive that nobody wanted to own on the way down. Whether SpaceX can fill its shoes requires an extraordinary amount to go right, said Lebenthal. Here's a look at how the two multi-trillion tech conglomerates stack up. Starlink, SpaceX's high-speed satellite-based internet service, is the company's current golden child, with $11.4 billion in revenue last year. It counts United Airlines , Carnival , Maersk, and John Deere as customers, and grew 50% year over year, with $4.4 billion in operating income at a 39% margin. Starlink is SpaceX's only profitable segment and a sum-of-the parts analysis from investment bank Stifel last week valued it at $1.25 trillion, just more than half of SpaceX's $2.45 trillion enterprise value. But there's a caveat. FactSet projects SpaceX will need to raise roughly $250 billion in debt over the next four years to fund its growth, according to Lebenthal, so a lot is riding on Starlink's shoulders. Amazon is the runt in this match-up. While Starlink has 9,600 satellites deployed and still in orbit, Amazon's Leo has just started to really get into a groove with about 330 satellites, according to Stifel. But Amazon sees big potential in space. In April, Amazon agreed to acquire Globalstar for $11.6 billion with the goal of expanding Leo's satellite network. And the company recently unveiled enterprise-grade Leo Ultra, which it says is the fastest satellite-internet antenna ever built. Amazon also inked deals with Delta Airlines and Jet Blue to expand wi-fi access on hundreds of aircraft in 2028. Amazon essentially invented the cloud business, and the company has the clear advantage right now. Amazon Web Services (AWS) posted $128.7 billion in revenue in 2025, with $45.6 billion in operating income at a 35% margin. AWS picked up the pace in the first quarter, growing 28% to $37.6 billion in revenue. Anthropic uses Amazon Trainium 2 chips to train Claude, and Amazon CEO Andy Jassy told investors that AWS's AI revenue run rate topped $15 billion in Q1 2026 and is "ascending rapidly." SpaceX is moving fast though. The company already has Colossus I and II data centers, and has signed lease deals with Anthropic and Google. And the company says its ultimate goal is to send the AI buildout into orbit. In 2025, SpaceX's AI segment generated $3.2 billion in total revenue against a $6.4 billion operating loss and in the first quarter of 2026 it lost $2.5 billion on $818 million in revenue. Dan Niles, founder of Niles Investment Management said SpaceX's compute operation today is more at a level with $5 billion CoreWeave or Amsterdam-based Nebius rather than at the level of AWS. Justin Menne, a portfolio manager at

Harbor Capital, sees it in terms of visibility. Amazon has a contracted backlog of $364 billion and competitive inference chips, he said, while SpaceX has plans to build. “I think in order to believe that the total enterprise value makes sense here, you’re inherently giving a lot of credibility to the management team, the engineering team, in order to actually execute,” said Menne. Menne said he hadn’t done any modeling on how much the Musk premium adds to SpaceX’s valuation but the non-technical answer is, “a lot,” he said. Lebenthal admires Musk’s accomplishments but called him “a source of discomfort” for some value investors. “It’s because he says outlandishly optimistic things,” Lebenthal said, Musk projected $1 trillion in revenue at SpaceX by 2030, while Lebenthal noted estimated revenues are about $40 billion for 2026. “You can’t just say that and $960 billion of incremental revenue is going to come to the table,” he said. SpaceX is an innovation stock that really appeals to investors who are dreamers, he added, like Ark Invest’s Cathie Wood. On SpaceX’s first day of trading, Wood’s Ark invested about half a billion in SpaceX, and has purchased more as the price has ebbed since its opening day. Amazon founder Jeff Bezos has a similar larger-than-life profile and reputation for entrepreneurial genius as Musk does. But Bezos transitioned from CEO to executive chairman in 2021 (he still reportedly has some involvement in important priorities like AI, but his day-to-day attention seems focused on Blue Origin, his space exploration company, and Prometheus, a new AI startup he cofounded). Harbor Capital’s Menne said there is no equivalent key-man premium at Amazon because “the current value of the company is less reliant on the next five years of executing on something that doesn’t already exist.” That said, Niles said there’s a clear alternative for investors drawn to Musk. The other public company where he serves as CEO, Tesla , has near-term initiatives that include robotics, autonomous fleets, and energy storage which “are likely to come to fruition before a colony on Mars,” said Niles. “Elon has this talent for making money for investors, even if crazy projections don’t play out,” said Menne. SpaceX’s prospectus claims a total addressable market of $28.5 trillion—roughly the size of the U.S. GDP. Of that, $22.7 trillion is a third-party estimate of the entire global “digital economy.” Menne said the enterprise AI portion “is really hard to underwrite because companies have only just started actually charging for a lot of these services in a way that’s not gross-margin negative.” Niles added that there’s inherent competition in that stratospheric figure. “There are some really pretty good companies in that space,” he said. “Maybe you can take all that share from Microsoft and others, but I think Microsoft is a pretty good company.” SpaceX is targeting a $1.6 trillion market for connectivity and $26.5 trillion for AI. But Amazon Leo is also gunning for the former. Amazon’s AWS generated $128.7 billion in cloud revenue last year, and hosts Anthropic and OpenAI while presiding over a $364 billion contracted backlog. Both can throw down gauntlets over the TAM, but Amazon can point to revenue of $716 billion last year to SpaceX’s $18.7 billion.

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The fate of Grail's stock will ultimately be decided in the cost-benefit calculations of medical insurers.

## Jeff Bezos' Ex-Wife Faces More Backlash After His Rival Targeted Her Spending of Their Divorce Settlement - StyleCaster

StyleCaster | 2026-07-11

MacKenzie Scott isn’t exactly a woman in the middle of controversies. She was married to Jeff Bezos for many years, the two divorced, she got a multimillion-dollar settlement, and then she pretty much disappeared from public life. Not just that, she’s been using her settlement to do good, vowing to donate most of her money to charity while she’s alive. She’s kept that promise, too, reportedly having donated around $26 billion since her divorce. Yes, billions, with a b. Ironically, she’s even richer now than when she started giving away money. Related Stories Ex-Government Head Joins Elon Musk in Targeting Jeff Bezos’ Ex-Wife After Report His New Wife Is Pushing Him to ‘Take Control’ Jeff Bezos’ Rival Just Targeted His Ex-Wife After Report His New Wife Is Pushing Him to ‘Take Control’ Instead of ‘Staying Silent’ According to the Bloomberg Billionaires Index , Scott’s net worth is around $34.4 billion, despite having given away over $20 billion already. How is that possible? It’s all due to the fact that her fortune is tied to Amazon shares, whose stock has risen more than 47% since April 2021, according to Fortune. That means she’s earning money faster than she can give it away. Scott received about 4% of Amazon stock, which was at that point worth around $36 billion. She’s reduced that stake by an estimated of 42%, but her net worth has still increased due to market appreciation. Of course, Scott is just likely to continue trying to give the money away. She’s given more than $5 billion per year in charitable distributions since 2019. Her ex-husband, Bezos, is worth around $270 billion. His lifetime charitable donations? Around $4.7 billion, or less than Scott has given every year. In fact, Bezos’s charitable contributions are roughly 1.7% of his net worth. Scott, meanwhile, has donated more than 40% of her net worth. Scott’s way of donating has also gotten some attention. Her foundation, Yield Giving, quietly researches to find organizations that need donations and Scott considers worthy. Then, they make the donation anonymously, so the gift doesn’t disrupt the work. There are no strings attached to the money. The foundation also runs open calls, publicly posting eligibility criteria. There are some, however, who don’t approve of her donations. On June 27, a social media user claimed that Scott’s donations were “making the world a worse place.” Elon Musk agreed and responded a day later, saying, “Sadly, yes.” Musk’s criticism aside, Scott was recently included in Forbes ‘ Iconoclast 50 list, which honored her as a leader “changing the game in real time, disrupting their industries and challenging the status quo.” As Forbes said, “A few generations back, being a major philanthropist meant setting up an organization that would exist in perpetuity (think the Ford Foundations) or establishing a university like Carnegie Mellon.

Bill Gates and Warren Buffett sped things up with their Giving Pledge, asking billionaire signers to give away their money during their lifetimes. But it took MacKenzie Scott to put it on warp speed." "The ex-wife of Amazon founder Jeff Bezos has given away $26.4 billion in less than seven years," the outlet added. "Last year she gave away an estimated $7.2 billion, the most by any individual worldwide since Forbes started keeping track in 2012. Scott (who is still worth $30.9 billion) has now given away more than 75% of the Amazon shares she received in her 2019 divorce."

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